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B.P.P. Statement On The Conviction Of Johnny Larry Spain

"S.Q. 6 JURY COLLABORATORS IN ASSASSINATION OF GEORGE JACKSON"



The following statement on the conviction of Johnny Larry Spain in the San Quentin 6 trial was issued by the Black Panther Party on August 12.

"The decision of the jury in the San Quentin Six case today reflected the impossibility of a Black person or, more, a member of the Black Panther Party to receive a fair trial in this country. Specifically, the harshest verdict, the conviction on two counts of first degree murder, was singly handed down to the only defendant who is a Black Panther Party member, Johnny Larry Spain. The only reasonable verdict for any or all of the defendants should have been not guilty. This nearly all-White, Marin County jury merely traded one life for others to create the semblance of justice for the record.

"The Black Panther Party denounces this verdict for it defies real and total justice, while implicating indirectly another of our comrades, who was outright assassinated on that August 21, 1971—George Jackson. The jury, by finding any defendant guilty, have become collaborators in the events of that day, which events included the government assassination of George Jackson, for clearly not one shred of evidence was ever presented to support a guilty verdict for any defendant. Johnny Spain was convicted of guilt by association, association with a friend, George Jackson, and with an organization, the Black Panther Party.

"Ultimately he will be free, one way or
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Black Panther Party Field Marshal GEORGE JACKSON (right) was assassinated on August 21, 1971, the result of a state conspiracy to destroy the revolutionary prison movement. Almost five years later BPP member and San Quentin 6 defendant JOHNNY SPAIN became another victim of this plot when he was falsely convicted on two counts of murder.

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